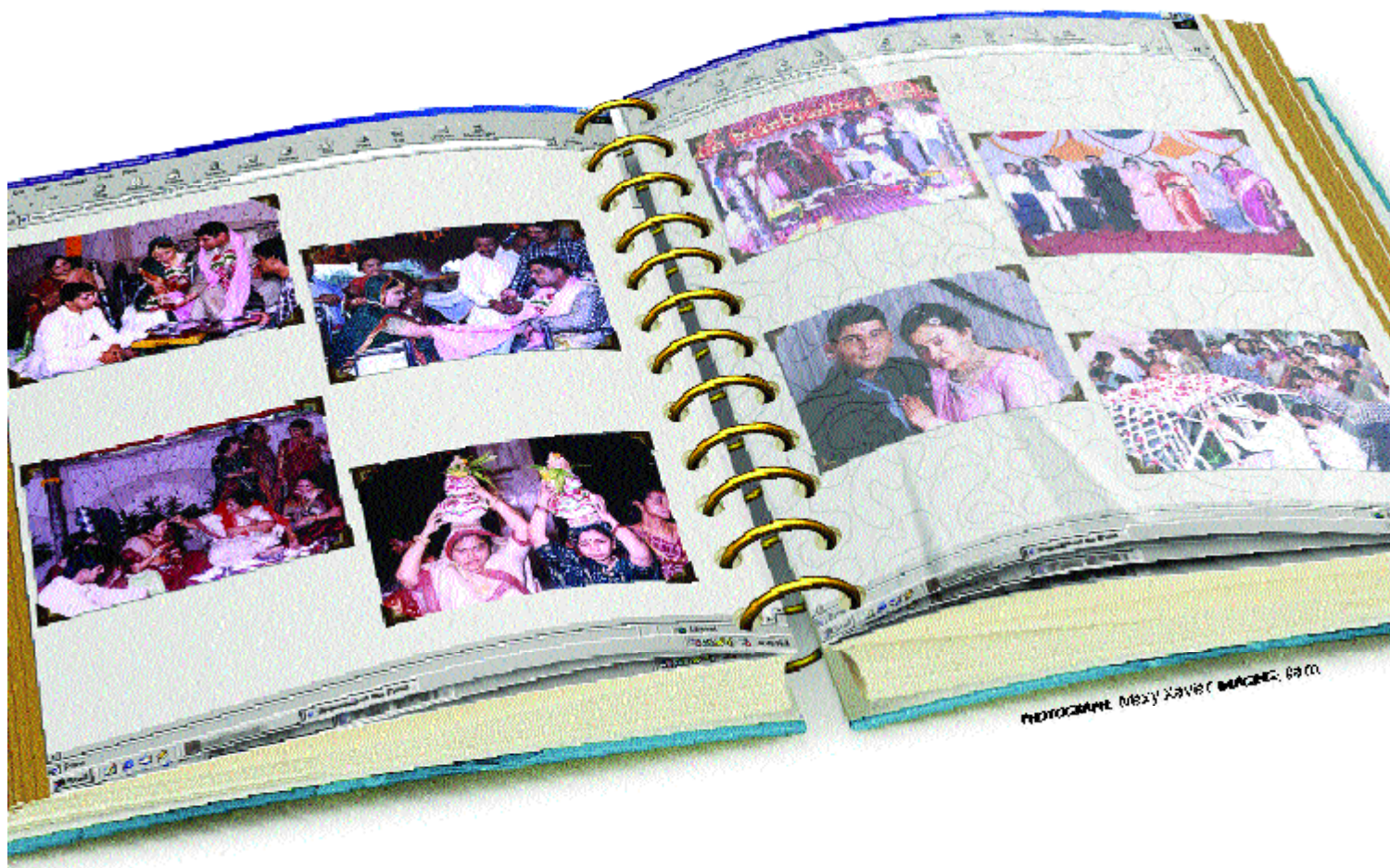




HOT SHOTS

Share your pictures, send photo greeting cards and even get T-shirts and ancillary merchandise with your picture on it—all through online photo album services

Tired of hauling out all those heavy albums each time you want to walk down memory lane? Sick of obliging all your relatives by ordering mass reprints of wedding snaps? Then maybe it's time you posted your pictures online. Online albums make it easier for you to share your pictures with friends and family, and you can use the Internet to do it for free. And confess it—don't many of you have old pictures that sit in dusty photo albums for years on end or even in the plastic envelopes they came in, without you casting a second glance at them?

"It never occurred to me to use a

photo gallery, until my brother had a baby and we wanted to send pictures out to friends and relatives all over the world," says Reshma, who has a nine-album photo gallery at photos.yahoo.com. "Besides, after I received a few death threats because of the bloated attachments I used to send," she adds, "I decided it would be safer to host them online!" Having an online photo album has the implicit advantage of not clogging other people's mailboxes with bloated photos—since they're in a central repository on the Internet, they can be accessed from anywhere by any person with the right access.

Go digital

If you have a digital camera, it becomes easier to create an online album. The idea of spending a small fortune on a digital camera, when there exist an abundance of cheap disposable cameras, might seem a bit odd, but digital cameras are getting cheaper and easier to use and there are savings to be made with them in the long term. The problem with an old fashioned camera is that film costs money. And there's always the worry of wasting a shot, or ending up with a bunch of boring pictures when you finally see the developed photos a few days later.

Digital cameras are matching up to